

The Source Map - Specification Package

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Every culture has named the divine differently — but the structures repeat. The unknowable Source. The Most High and the divine council. The craftsman-god who shaped this world. The rulers who govern it. The light-bringers who descend to wake us up.

This repository contains the complete specification for **The Source Map** — a comparative cosmology feature that maps every documented deity, divine concept, and cosmological figure across world traditions onto a single four-tier hierarchy derived from Gnostic cosmology.

The methodology label for users: **Comparative Esotericism / Perennial Cosmology** — mapping the Source across traditions using the Gnostic four-tier framework as the interpretive key.

Repository structure

```
source-map-spec/  
├─ README.md                ← you are here  
├─ docs/  
│   ├─ 01-comparative-cosmology-spec.md    ← the original feature spec  
│   ├─ 02-structural-cross-comparison.md    ← methodology for parallels  
│   ├─ 03-scholarly-mode.md                ← academic caveat layer  
│   └─ 04-practices-layer.md                ← ascent practices per  
tradition  
│   └─ 05-personal-layer-and-my-map.md      ← user-saved layers, forking,  
sharing  
│   └─ 06-connection-evidence-schema.md    ← evidence types for user-  
drawn lines  
├─ methodology/  
│   └─ master-prompt.md                  ← combined prompt for building  
chat  
├─ scripts/  
│   └─ self_test.py                     ← validates all docs are  
internally consistent  
└─ tests/  
    └─ test_outputs.md                   ← results of the self-test run
```

How to use this package

For the building chat (Claude or another assistant)

Paste `methodology/master-prompt.md` into the chat alongside the original `Comparative_Cosmology_Feature.pdf`. The master prompt references every document in `docs/` and gives the assistant binding instructions for applying them consistently.

For the GitHub repo

Each file in `docs/` is a self-contained markdown document. They can be rendered by GitHub directly, ingested into a documentation site (Docusaurus, MkDocs, Nextra), or converted to PDF using `scripts/` utilities.

For a future developer

The data schema, UI spec, and database seed are all in `docs/01`. The methodology that governs how new nodes are added is in `docs/02`. The scholarly caveat layer is in `docs/03`. The actionable user-facing layer (practices, personal maps, evidence types) is in `docs/04` – `docs/06`.

The four-tier framework at a glance

Tier	Name	Function	Example figures
1	Unmanifest Source	The ineffable ground of being	Monad, Ein Sof, Brahman, Tao, Nun, Ginnungagap
2	True Most High / Divine Council	First manifestation, head of council	El Elyon, the Aeons, Anu, Ahura Mazda, Atum, Keter
3	Demiurge	Flawed craftsman who shaped matter	Yaldabaoth, Yahweh (Gnostic reading), Marduk, Brahma-egoic
4	Archons / Rulers	Planetary powers, principalities	Seven Archons, Watchers, Olympians, Igigi, Daevas
Cross-Tier	Light-Bringers / Liberators	Bridge tiers; wake humanity	Sophia, Christ-Aeon, Prometheus, Hermes, Thoth, Enki, Loki

Editorial principles

1. **Proponent voice by default.** Each tradition speaks in its own voice without disclaimers in default mode.
 2. **Scholarly mode as a toggle.** Academic context, source criticism, and contested identifications appear in a parallel panel when the user opts in.
 3. **Structural function over surface similarity.** Two figures are parallel if they perform the same cosmic role — not because they share a name, animal, or planet.
 4. **Living traditions respected.** Practitioners of the traditions mapped here may disagree with comparative readings. The framework offers synthesis, not replacement.
 5. **Genealogical vs. typological distinguished.** Documented historical transmission is flagged. Pattern-based parallels are flagged differently.
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Intellectual lineage

The framework draws on:

- Pico della Mirandola, *Oratio de hominis dignitate* (1486)
- Marsilio Ficino, *Prisca Theologia*
- Manly P. Hall, *The Secret Teachings of All Ages* (1928)
- H.P. Blavatsky, *The Secret Doctrine* (1888)
- René Guénon and Traditionalist comparative work
- Wouter Hanegraaff's academic comparative esotericism

Critical balance is provided through Hanegraaff, Karen King, Michael Williams, Mark S. Smith, Steven Katz, and the working scholars cited in `docs/03`.

Status

This is a specification package — not running code. The next step is for a development chat to:

1. Expand each node in the initial node list to a full data record per the schema
2. Generate a JSON seed file
3. Build the canvas UI with the four-tier layout
4. Implement drag-to-connect, side-panel detail, filters, and view-mode toggles
5. Wire in the scholarly-mode panel and the practices layer

The master prompt in `methodology/master-prompt.md` is designed to be handed to that chat as the source of truth.

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Content authored by the project team. Scholarly citations are listed within `docs/03` and remain the intellectual property of their respective authors. The four-tier interpretive framework is derived from Sethian and Valentinian Gnostic primary texts (Nag Hammadi Codices) and is in the public domain.